DATA CONSOLIDATION · EXCEL, POWER QUERY, DATA MODEL

From scattered records to one clear view of the business

LITCHFIELDS GRAIN

Litchfields Grain is a family-run maize company in Te Puke, Bay of Plenty. Three separate sets of records became one dashboard and a short list of practical next steps.

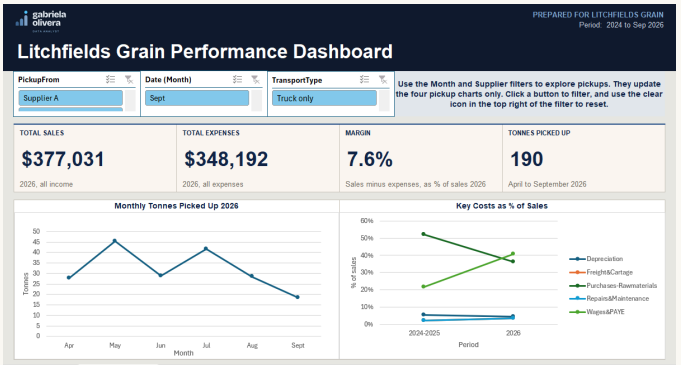
THE CHALLENGE

The business kept its numbers in three places: an income and expenses report from Xero, a sales-by-product inventory report, and grain pickup records. Each used its own layout, and product codes were written differently in each, so nothing could be compared. Decisions about pricing and costs were made without a joined-up picture.

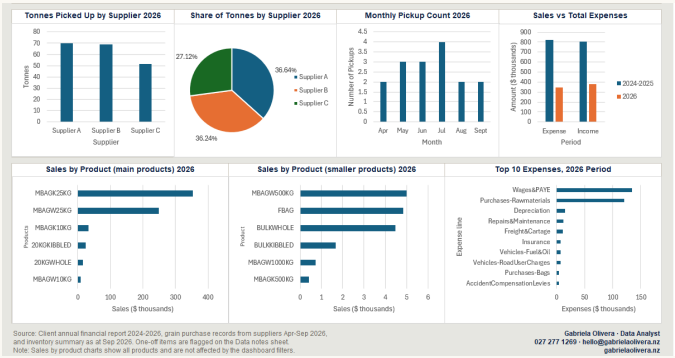
WHAT I DID

I combined the three sources into one data model with Power Query, built a shared product key so the reports could be matched, and logged every data-quality issue and cleaning decision (18 findings, 17 decisions). On top of that I built an interactive Excel dashboard with four headline measures, eight charts and filters by month, supplier and transport type, plus a one-page report with recommendations.

$377K	92%	7.6%	190
2026 SALES	EXPENSES AS % OF SALES	MARGIN, 2026	TONNES PICKED UP, APR TO SEP



DASHBOARD, HEADLINE MEASURES AND TRENDS



DASHBOARD, SUPPLIERS, PRODUCTS AND COSTS

WHAT THE DATA SHOWED

- **Costs came down.** Expenses fell from just over 100% of sales in the start-up period to 92% in 2026.
- **Two products carry the business.** Two products generate more than 80% of product sales.
- **Wages and raw materials dominate costs,** so price, not cutting spend, is the main lever for margin.
- **Supply is well spread.** Three suppliers each provide between 27% and 37% of the grain, so there is no heavy reliance on one.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

- **Set the price** of the two main products at the level that reaches the target margin, and review it when costs change.
- **Record the price per tonne** from each supplier and the type of grain on each pickup, to compare suppliers while keeping supply spread.
- **Record purchase and delivery costs:** the cost of the five best sellers and what free local delivery takes, to see margin by product.
- **Plan cash flow and storage** around the peak months, May and July.

Result. The business moved from three disconnected sets of records to one view of sales, costs, margin and supply, and it now has a clear list of what to record from today so that future pricing and margin decisions rest on better information.

Delivered free of charge as a portfolio project. All figures and supplier names have been changed for confidentiality; the client's data is not shared. Published with the client's permission.

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